

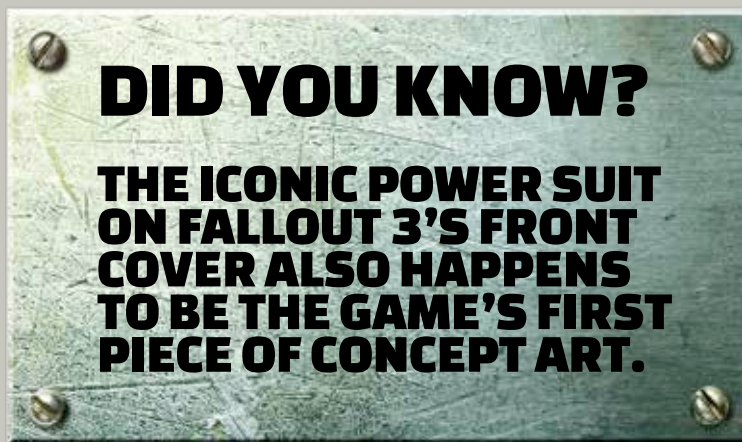
harsh aftermath of nuclear warfare. Yes drinking water is important and the Vault absolutely needs it to survive but clean drinking water can wait. Afterall, there's so much to do! People to meet, side quests to pick up, areas to explore, easter eggs to find etc. You could recruit the more helpful NPCs, also including but not restricted to Dogmeat, your bestest pal ever. Your PIPBoy 2000 took care of all the mapping, quest tracking and ability management. The game was isometric of course, looked great, turn-based combat also worked great. Gawd the game was just great overall.

As the player, you had a total of 150 days to find a replacement chip. Add another 350 to that for dealing with the Children of the Cathedral cultists. Oh, and also an army of super mutants who are armed to the teeth. No pressure. The best part about the game was that players could decide how they were going to deal with the situation. You could charm your way through and avoid fighting entirely, or maybe you could borrow some firepower from the Brotherhood of Steel, or you know, you could just sell-out the Vault to the super mutants for some lols and a nice payday.

Well dayum, we definitely need a sequel now

Needless to say Fallout was an instant hit. The spiritual successor to Wasteland had earned its place in the "best of all time" lists and even the harshest of critics were showering it with praises.

Fallout didn't do as well as expected, we mean for how great a game it was and how well it was received, one would expect more from it in a financial sense. Where it didn't quite match up. However, it had developed a fan following now. A rabid fan following who demanded a sequel, who wanted more of the Fallout universe. So more they would get, they were already set up for



a sequel anyway, with most of the code already in place. The newly dubbed Black Isle Studios got right to it, and Urquhart decided that it would be twice as big as the last. He was given just fifteen months from the release of the original to finish up with the sequel.

Fallout 2 made some fixes to the AI and their obstructive behaviour. There were 14 quirky, and very memorable possible companions this time around. Also including Dogmeat, who's well over eighty years old now. Wow, that's one healthy dog (maybe a ghoul?). A few graphical updates here and there but otherwise, at its core the engine remained the same. But there was still a lot left to do and not enough time to do it. There was simply too much on everyone's plate. What ensued was a lot of resignations and the result was that pretty much none of the original crew were left working on the sequel. Development was split between two teams who had no idea what the other was doing and the game was put together just two weeks before it was scheduled for disk duplication. But it somehow clicked, sort of.

Fallout 2 had you playing as the Chosen One, a direct descendant of the OG Vault Dweller. You're forced to leave the settlement the Vault Dweller founded because of harsh drought conditions. The only way to ensure the settlement lives is to search for a G.E.C.K. (Garden of Eden Creation Kit). After a tutorial where you get your PIP-Boy and your jumpsuit, you're off on your own epic adventure. This time around you have to deal with a mutant

hating president and his Enclave. Which is pretty much the remnants of the US government. Richardson – the "President" of the Enclave – has kidnapped the people of your settlement for use as his test subjects. So you need to make your way to the Enclave's offshore oil rig base to beat the boss and rescue them. Once again, PLENTY of

side quests to do, most of them weird to boot. The map was huge, so much so that you actually needed an automated car to get around.

Black Isle managed to make their seemingly impossible deadline, but maybe they should've held off for a while. The game was rife with bugs. Lots and lots of bugs. Multiple patches were released but you can't patch up a buggy reputation. Sales also didn't quite match up to Fallout 1. Critics scored it well, considering it was most of the same, and the "same" was already good. However, some did criticise the lack of any innovation. But the fans didn't care. They loved the game nonetheless.

Some not-so-fallout Fallout

The next Fallout title to grace us wasn't exactly a Fallout title. Well it was, but just in name. It looks like Interplay wasn't really too keen on the Fallout franchise, and Micro Forte, an Australian developer caught the IP. What they gave us was Fallout Tactics: Brotherhood of Steel. As the name suggests, it was a tactics game. Nothing less nothing more. No huge world to explore, no side quests to do, no conversations. If anything the game dumped quite few RPG elements in favor of more combat oriented options. Sure it was a nice tactics game, but it wasn't a Fallout game. Not a real Fallout game anyway.

The Journey to Fallout 3

Come 2000, Black Isle's just a small crew now, working on a new 3D engine from scratch for Interplay's next big